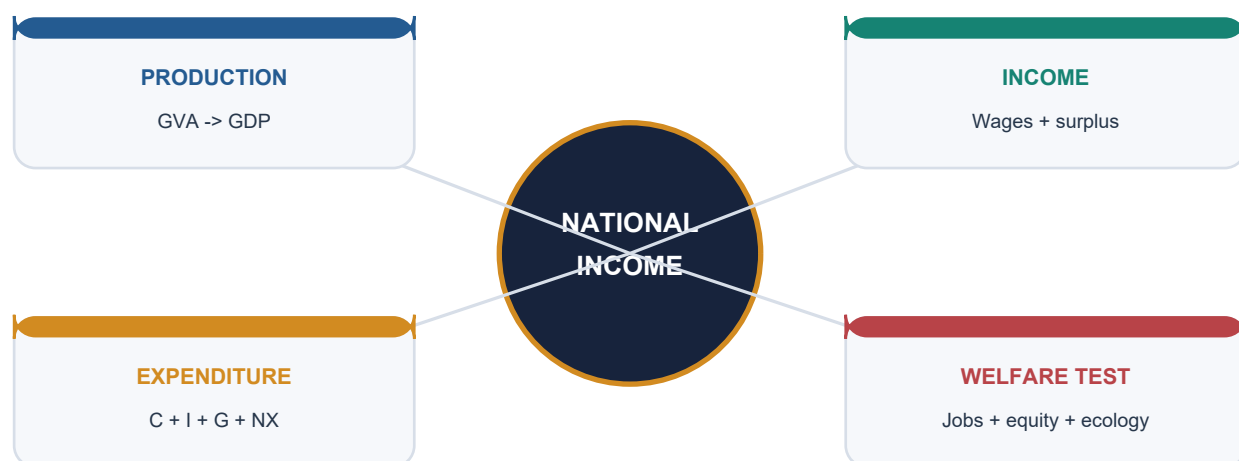


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

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Deterministic fallback visual: national income viewed through production, income, expenditure and welfare lenses.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

PYQ, practice and solved workbook

Solved directly routed Mains PYQs

Provenance rule: The seven 2018-2023 demands are routed by the audited Core owner. The 2024 GS-II Q3 wording is verified in the cross-owned Polity 11/16 packages. Neutral wording is used where exact UPSC wording has not been independently reproduced here.

PYQ-M1. 2018 GS-II Q4 - Usefulness of parliamentary committees, especially the Estimates Committee

Demand decoding

- “Discuss” requires functions, usefulness, limitations and a balanced conclusion.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** use three institutional units, not a catalogue of every committee.

Model answer

Claim: Parliamentary committees are indispensable “working rooms” of Parliament because they preserve detailed scrutiny when plenary time is scarce.

Named evidence: The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members**, excludes ministers and examines budget estimates for economy, efficiency and administrative improvement. It complements the **PAC**, which audits CAG findings after expenditure, and **CoPU**, which specialises in public undertakings. The **24 DRSCs**, each with 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha members, examine demands for grants, referred Bills and ministry reports.

Analysis: Small membership, evidence-taking, continuity and less theatrical party competition allow technical and often cross-party scrutiny. Estimates scrutiny is preventive: it asks whether public money can be spent better before audit identifies failure.

Qualification: Reports are advisory; attendance, research support and Bill referral vary. Estimates recommendations cannot themselves alter grants.

Verdict: Committees do not replace the House, but they make its financial and legislative control credible. Routine referral and stronger follow-up would increase their usefulness.

Examiner note: Exact Estimates-PAC-CoPU differentiation, DRSC evidence and one limitation make this complete rather than descriptive.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named committee units plus a qualified verdict.

PYQ-M2. 2019 GS-II Q15 - Decline of the individual parliamentarian and debate quality

Demand decoding

- “Discuss” requires mechanisms causing decline, surviving opportunities and reforms.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** separate member autonomy, House time and scrutiny quality.

Model answer

Claim: The individual MP's law-making role has declined because party and executive institutions increasingly determine both the vote and the agenda.

Named evidence and analysis: First, the **Tenth Schedule** makes defiance of a party direction potentially disqualifying. This stabilises government but converts many legislative choices into party commands. Second, the executive controls most government business and drafting; limited sitting time, disruption and the **guillotine** can pass demands without discussion. Third, fewer or selective referrals to **DRSCs** remove the main site for clause-level, evidence-based scrutiny. Fourth, ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** Money Bill route can compress prior bicameral deliberation. Finally, the rarity of successful Private Members' Bills signals limited non-government law-making space.

Counter-evidence: MPs still use starred questions, Zero Hour, motions, committee reports, amendments and constituency knowledge. Rajya Sabha scrutiny and opposition-led PAC work can produce institutional effects even without defeating the government.

Qualification: Decline varies with majority size, coalition politics, committee referral and presiding-officer practice; it is not a constitutional disappearance of the MP.

Verdict: The parliamentarian has shifted from autonomous law-maker toward party-linked scrutiniser. Predictable sittings, default committee referral and a whip confined to confidence/core finance would restore deliberation without destabilising government.

Examiner note: The answer explains the causal chain and acknowledges surviving agency; it does not confuse low autonomy with legal powerlessness.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 5 mechanisms, 2 counter-instruments and 3 reforms.

PYQ-M3. 2020 GS-II Q5 - “Once a Speaker, always a Speaker” and objectivity

Demand decoding

- Answer both parts: whether the convention operates in India and its implications for objectivity.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** one institutional contrast, three powers, one reform.

Model answer

Claim: The British convention that a Speaker severs party ties and is normally returned unopposed does not operate in India; therefore neutrality rests more on individual conduct than institutional insulation.

Named evidence: Under **Articles 93-97**, the Speaker controls procedure and discipline. The office also certifies a Money Bill under **Article 110**, presides over an **Article 108** joint sitting and decides Tenth Schedule petitions subject to *Kihoto Hollohan*. The Speaker retains party membership and ordinarily contests again on a party ticket.

Analysis: These high-stakes powers can affect bicameralism, government survival and member status. A party-linked career therefore creates a perception of bias even when a decision is legally defensible. Delayed defection rulings and disputed Money Bill certification intensify the concern.

Qualification: Article 94 continuity after dissolution, charged salary and House removal safeguards provide some independence; party origin does not prove actual partisanship.

Verdict: “Once a Speaker, always a Speaker” is aspirational, not Indian practice. Reasoned rulings, political detachment and independent defection adjudication would make objectivity structural.

Examiner note: Direct convention answer plus powers-mechanism-qualification sequence satisfies both limbs.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named powers and one balanced reform.

PYQ-M4. 2020 GS-II Q14 - Rajya Sabha as a supporting organ

Demand decoding

- “Highlight factors and areas” requires separate treatment of causes and fields of subordination.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** avoid the absolute claim that Rajya Sabha is inferior everywhere.

Model answer

Claim: Rajya Sabha is a supporting chamber in finance and confidence, but a co-equal or distinctive chamber in ordinary law, constitutional amendment and federal protection.

Areas of subordination: Under **Articles 109-110**, it can only recommend changes to a Money Bill within fourteen days. It cannot vote demands for grants, and **Article 75(3)** gives only Lok Sabha the confidence key. In an **Article 108** joint sitting, Lok Sabha's larger numbers usually prevail.

Factors: Direct election gives Lok Sabha stronger popular legitimacy; executive survival is tied to its majority; and disputed use of the Money Bill route can bypass the Upper House. Political disruption and limited referral can further weaken revision.

Counter-evidence: Rajya Sabha has equal power over ordinary Bills and **Article 368** amendments. As a permanent House it supplies continuity. Its two exclusive powers - **Article 249** State List legislation in the national interest and **Article 312** creation of All-India Services - make it a federal gatekeeper. It also shares committee scrutiny and national debate.

Qualification: State representation is population-weighted, not equal-per-State; its federal design is therefore weaker than a senate based on State equality.

Verdict: Rajya Sabha supports Lok Sabha without being subordinate to it. The label is accurate only where the Constitution deliberately prioritises popular control over money and government survival.

Examiner note: Separates “factors” from “areas” and gives a degree-based verdict with Articles 249/312.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 3 subordinate fields, 4 counterweights and one design caveat.

PYQ-M5. 2021 GS-II Q4 - Extent of Parliament's executive accountability

Demand decoding

- “To what extent” demands a graded judgment, not a list of devices.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** instruments -> limits -> degree-based verdict.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament possesses a comprehensive accountability toolkit, but its effectiveness is conditional on time, information and party incentives.

Named evidence: Starred questions and supplementaries compel ministerial explanation; Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions expose policy failure. **Article 75(3)** enables Lok Sabha no-confidence control. **Articles 112-114** require budget presentation, voting of grants and appropriation. **PAC-CAG** audit and **DRSC** scrutiny extend control beyond the floor.

Analysis: These instruments cover the full administrative cycle - information, authorisation, ongoing criticism, financial audit and ultimate removal.

Qualification: A secure majority and the Tenth Schedule make government defeat unlikely. Disruptions, the guillotine, limited sitting days, selective committee referral and ordinances can weaken scrutiny.

Verdict: Accountability is constitutionally strong but behaviourally uneven: Parliament usually extracts information and audit, yet only exceptionally threatens executive survival. Protected scrutiny time and stronger committees would narrow the gap.

Examiner note: “Extent” is answered explicitly by distinguishing routine oversight from survival control.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 evidence families and 4 limitations.

PYQ-M6. 2021 GS-II Q15 - Working of DRSCs in enforcing executive control

Demand decoding

- “Evaluate” requires criteria: design, performance, weaknesses and final assessment.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** exact composition is essential.

Model answer

Claim: DRSCs are Parliament's most capable instrument of continuous ministry-wise oversight, but they enforce control through information and persuasion rather than binding command.

Named evidence: Introduced as **17 committees in 1993** and restructured to **24 from 2004**, each now has **31 members - 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha**; sixteen are Lok Sabha-secretariat serviced and eight Rajya Sabha-secretariat serviced. Ministers are barred. They examine demands for grants, referred Bills, annual reports and long-term policy.

Analysis: Their smaller forum permits evidence-taking, clause scrutiny, technical learning and cross-party consensus away from floor grandstanding. Demand-for-grants reports connect policy priorities with spending; Bill reports improve legal design; action-taken reports sustain follow-up.

Weaknesses: Referral is not automatic, recommendations are non-binding, terms are only one year, attendance and research support can be weak, and the government may provide delayed or formalistic responses. Major Bills passed without referral show that effectiveness depends on executive and presiding-officer choices.

Qualification: Non-binding status is not uselessness: reasoned reports shape debate, media and later policy, while final law and supply must remain with the House.

Verdict: DRSCs work effectively when used, but are under-used. Default referral, longer specialisation, expert staff and public reasons for bypass would convert potential into systematic control.

Examiner note: Exact 1993/2004 and 21+10 controls, functions and enforceability distinction produce an evaluative answer.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 235-250 words; 4 functions, 5 weaknesses and 4 reforms.

PYQ-M7. 2023 GS-II Q16 - Committee structure and role of financial committees

Demand decoding

- "Explain the structure" requires classification before evaluating the financial arm.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** use exact committee compositions.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament's committee system combines permanent subject/House oversight with task-specific inquiry; its financial committees operationalise the constitutional power of the purse.

Structure: Standing committees include financial committees, 24 DRSCs, House-management committees and oversight bodies such as Subordinate Legislation, Privileges, Ethics, Government Assurances and Welfare of SCs/STs. **Ad hoc committees** include Select/Joint Committees on Bills and JPCs formed for a specified inquiry.

Named financial evidence: The **PAC** has **22 members (15 LS + 7 RS)**, is conventionally chaired by the Opposition and examines CAG reports after expenditure. The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members only** and seeks economy and administrative improvement before or during expenditure planning. **CoPU** has **22 members (15+7)** and specialises in public undertakings. Ministers are barred from all three.

Analysis: Estimates supplies prospective efficiency scrutiny, PAC retrospective legality/regularity scrutiny and CoPU institution-specific commercial accountability. DRSC examination of demands bridges these stages.

Qualification: Reports are advisory, PAC ordinarily avoids questioning policy itself and referral/follow-up may be weak.

Verdict: The structure substitutes depth for scarce floor time; its financial arm closes the authorisation-audit loop but needs stronger research and action-taken enforcement.

Examiner note: Begins with the required architecture, then explains rather than merely names each financial committee.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; classification plus exact 22/30/22 evidence.

PYQ-M8. 2024 GS-II Q3 - Cabinet growth and marginalisation of parliamentary supremacy

Demand decoding

- "Elucidate" requires a mechanism showing how cabinet growth affects Parliament.
- "Parliamentary supremacy" must mean effective control/deliberation, not UK-style legal sovereignty.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** three mechanisms, correctives and qualified verdict.

Model answer

Claim: The cabinet remains responsible to Lok Sabha under **Article 75(3)**, yet fusion of executive and legislature can let a disciplined cabinet majority dominate the institution meant to control it.

Named evidence and analysis: The Tenth Schedule whip reduces independent voting; the government controls most Bills and House time; guillotining demands, selective DRSC referral and compressed debate weaken scrutiny. Ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** route can reduce prior legislative and bicameral examination. PMO-centred coordination may add prime-ministerial dominance over cabinet dominance.

Qualification: Parliament still authorises supply, may remove the ministry, asks questions and uses PAC-CAG/DRSC scrutiny. Courts enforce constitutional limits and elections renew responsibility.

Verdict: Cabinet growth has marginalised Parliament's deliberative and control functions, not transferred constitutional sovereignty. Predictable sittings, routine committee scrutiny and narrower whip use can restore responsible fusion.

Examiner note: It clarifies the proposition, proves the mechanism and avoids the sovereignty trap.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 mechanisms, 3 correctives and one reform verdict.

Routed Parliament Prelims demand laboratory

Answer-key provenance: For 2018-2023, official keys are not held locally. For 2024-2025, official Set-A keys are held locally but no option letter is reproduced or inferred here. For 2026, the locally held Set-A keys are provisional and no option letter is reproduced or inferred. Each entry therefore gives the doctrinal solution and elimination logic, not an invented key.

2018-2023 routed demands: 11

Year/ Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2018 Q1	First Lok Sabha opposition/LoP history	LoP is a statutory office under the 1977 Act; Core applies the one-tenth recognition threshold. Distinguish largest opposition party from recognised LoP.	Official key unavailable locally; do not invent first-party identity without exact source.
2018 Q20	Committee scrutinising delegated legislation	Committee on Subordinate Legislation examines whether delegated powers are properly exercised.	Not PAC, Estimates or Government Assurances.
2018 Q31	Money Bill definition/procedure	Article 110 “only” test; Lok Sabha origin; President recommendation; Speaker certificate; Rajya Sabha recommendations within 14 days; no joint sitting.	Official key unavailable locally; resolve each statement doctrinally.
2019 Q49	Parliament Disqualification Act/office of profit	Articles 102/103 plus Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959; President decides a sitting-member question after ECI opinion.	Exemption is office-specific, not a general immunity.
2019 Q69	Committees reviewing independent regulators	No single general “regulators committee”; relevant DRSC scrutinises the regulator with its parent ministry and subject field.	Committee jurisdiction follows ministry/subject allocation.
2020 Q2	Rajya Sabha powers equal to Lok Sabha	Equal on ordinary Bills, constitutional amendments and specified elections; unequal on Money Bills, demands and confidence; RS alone initiates Articles 249/312.	Avoid absolute equal/unequal statements.
2020 Q3	MPLADS inspection/carry-forward	MPLADS is a scheme; funds are non-lapsable and carry forward; utilisation is monitored/inspected under the scheme framework.	No current per-MP rupee amount is quoted without live official verification.
2020 Q20	Sessions, summoning and minimum sittings	President summons under Article 85; gap between sessions cannot exceed six months; no constitutional minimum sitting-day count.	Three named sessions are convention, not constitutional compulsion.
2022 Q15	Exclusive Lok Sabha powers	Money Bill origin/certification route, voting demands and holding confidence key are Lok Sabha domains; distinguish from shared legislative powers.	RS has separate Articles 249/312 powers.
2022 Q20	Deputy Speaker election and powers	House elects under Article 93; when presiding, Deputy has Speaker's powers and casting vote; answerable to House, not Speaker; no constitutional deadline.	Do not assume a current vacancy without verification.
2023 Q37	Finance Bill and Money Bill procedure	Money Bill is the narrow Article 110 subset. Financial Bill-I starts in LS on recommendation but RS has full power; Financial Bill-II may start in either House and recommendation is needed before consideration.	“All Money Bills are Financial Bills, not vice versa.”

2024-2025 routed demands: 7

Year/ Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2024 Q68	Article 109/Money Bill and Rajya Sabha	RS cannot reject/amend; it recommends within 14 days; LS may reject recommendations; no return means deemed passage in LS form.	Official Set-A key exists locally; no option letter recorded here.
2024 Q80	Lok Sabha Ethics Committee	Examines unethical conduct of members; distinct from Privileges Committee, which addresses privilege/contempt.	Do not merge ethical misconduct and institutional privilege.
2024 Q81	Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam	106th Amendment: Arts 330A/332A/334A; enacted 2023, commenced 16 Apr 2026, reservation not operational pending publication -> delimitation sequence.	Official key exists; current status updated beyond exam date. No 2041 calculation.
2024 Q93	Speaker during removal resolution	Article 96: Speaker does not preside; may speak and vote in first instance, but no casting vote in that proceeding.	Removal requires effective majority and 14 days' notice.
2024 Q94	Bill lapse on dissolution	Lapses if pending in LS or passed LS/pending RS; survives if pending only in RS, awaiting assent, returned, or joint sitting notified.	Apply status, not a blanket rule.
2024 Q95	Prorogation/dissolution	Both are President's acts under Article 85; prorogation ends session and Bills survive; dissolution ends LS life; adjournment is chair's act.	RS is never dissolved.
2025 Q87	Speaker after dissolution/party resignation	Speaker continues until immediately before new House first sitting; Indian Speaker need not resign party membership.	Official Set-A key exists; no option letter recorded here.

2026 routed demands: 2

Year/ Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2026 Q58	Starred, unstarred and supplementary questions	Starred: oral and supplementary allowed; unstarred: written and no supplementaries; supplementary is follow-up to oral answer; short-notice is a distinct urgent oral category.	Local Set-A key is provisional; no option letter recorded or inferred.
2026 Q59	Welfare of SCs/STs Committee	30 members = 20 LS + 10 RS; one-year term; chair appointed by Speaker; ministers barred; examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation.	Parliamentary committee, not the constitutional Commissions. Provisional-key caution applies.

Original MCQ loop - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Constitutional composition

Parliament under Article 79 consists of:

A. President, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha B. Prime Minister, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha C. President and Lok Sabha only D. Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha only

Answer: A. [FACT] The President is an integral organ of Parliament though not a member of either House.

OM2. Rajya Sabha election

Which correctly describes election of elected Rajya Sabha members from States?

A. Direct FPTP through territorial constituencies B. Proportional representation by single transferable vote through elected MLAs C. List proportional representation through all adults D. Nomination by Governors after Assembly consultation

Answer: B. [FACT] Elected MLAs form the electorate; the 2003 statutory change introduced open ballot.

OM3. Seat-freeze extension

Which amendment extended readjustment until publication of figures of the first census taken after 2026?

A. 42nd Amendment B. 61st Amendment C. 84th Amendment D. 87th Amendment

Answer: C. [FACT] The 42nd began the freeze; the 84th extended it; the 87th changed the boundary-readjustment census basis to 2001.

OM4. Lok Sabha nomination

Which statement is correct?

A. The President may presently nominate two Anglo-Indians to Lok Sabha. B. Lok Sabha has twelve nominated members. C. Anglo-Indian nomination was converted into Rajya Sabha nomination. D. The 104th Amendment ended the Anglo-Indian nomination provision for Lok Sabha.

Answer: D. [FACT] Present Lok Sabha composition has no nominated Anglo-Indian members.

OM5. Article 84

Which is a constitutional qualification for Parliament membership?

A. Citizenship of India B. Prior legislative experience C. Graduation from a recognised university D. Residence for ten years in the represented State

Answer: A. [FACT] Citizenship, prescribed oath, minimum age and statutory qualifications form the gate.

OM6. Sitting-member disqualification

Who decides an Article 102(1) question concerning a sitting MP?

A. Speaker acting alone B. President after obtaining the Election Commission's opinion C. Supreme Court in original jurisdiction D. Returning Officer

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 103 creates the President-ECI decision route.

OM7. Leader of Opposition

Which statement best reflects the Core control?

A. LoP is a purely constitutional office named in Article 75. B. The largest opposition leader automatically becomes LoP in all circumstances. C. LoP is statutory under the 1977 Act and recognition practice uses a one-tenth threshold. D. LoP is appointed by the President.

Answer: C. [FACT] Distinguish the statutory recognised office from the political leader of the largest opposition party.

OM8. Prorogation

Prorogation:

A. Ends the life of Lok Sabha. B. Is ordered by the Speaker. C. Causes every pending Bill to lapse. D. Ends a session through presidential action while pending Bills generally survive.

Answer: D. [FACT] Adjournment is by the chair; dissolution, not prorogation, ends Lok Sabha.

OM9. Starred question

A starred question ordinarily:

A. Receives an oral answer and permits supplementary questions. B. Receives only a written answer. C. Cannot concern a ministry. D. Is identical to Zero Hour.

Answer: A. [FACT] Oral follow-up makes starred questions the principal live cross-examination device.

OM10. No-confidence motion

Which is correct?

- A. It can be moved in either House. B. It belongs only to Lok Sabha and needs support of 50 members for admission. C. It must specify charges against each minister. D. Its defeat dissolves Rajya Sabha.

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 75(3) ties collective responsibility to Lok Sabha; reasons need not be stated.

OM11. Speaker after dissolution

On dissolution of Lok Sabha, the Speaker:

- A. Vacates immediately with all members. B. Continues for six months. C. Continues until immediately before the first sitting of the new Lok Sabha. D. Becomes a Rajya Sabha officer.

Answer: C. [FACT] Article 94 preserves institutional continuity.

OM12. Speaker's removal resolution

While a resolution for the Speaker's removal is considered:

- A. The Speaker presides and uses only a casting vote. B. The Deputy Speaker cannot preside. C. The Speaker cannot enter the House. D. The Speaker does not preside, may vote in the first instance and has no casting vote.

Answer: D. [FACT] Article 96 removes the conflict in presiding, not the member's right to participate.

OM13. Sita Soren

The 2024 seven-judge ruling establishes that:

- A. Legislative privilege does not immunise acceptance of a bribe for speech or vote. B. All parliamentary speech may be criminally prosecuted. C. Article 105 has been invalidated. D. Only actual voting, not bribe acceptance, can complete bribery.

Answer: A. [FACT] The offence is complete on acceptance; bona fide speech/vote immunity survives.

OM14. Ordinary Bill deadlock

Which is a recognised Article 108 trigger?

- A. Rajya Sabha recommends changes to a Money Bill. B. The second House rejects an ordinary Bill or the Houses finally disagree. C. States refuse to ratify an amendment. D. President returns a Bill.

Answer: B. [FACT] Eligible deadlocks include rejection, final disagreement and specified delay; Money and amendment Bills are excluded.

OM15. Money Bill

Which condition is essential?

- A. It may include any policy matter if taxation is also present. B. Rajya Sabha must consent within fourteen days. C. It must contain only Article 110 matters and incidental provisions. D. A joint sitting resolves disagreement.

Answer: C. [FACT] "Only" is the classification firewall; Rajya Sabha recommendations are non-binding.

OM16. Financial Bill-II

Which statement is correct?

- A. It is always a Money Bill. B. It can originate only in Lok Sabha. C. Rajya Sabha has recommendation-only power. D. It may originate in either House, with presidential recommendation required before consideration.

Answer: D. [FACT] Article 117(3) differs from both Money Bill and Financial Bill-I.

OM17. Joint-sitting history

How many joint sittings had been held according to the controlled Core?

- A. Three B. Four C. Five D. One

Answer: A. [FACT] Dowry 1961, Banking Service 1978 and POTA 2002.

OM18. Bill lapse

Which Bill lapses on Lok Sabha dissolution?

- A. Bill pending in Rajya Sabha and never passed by Lok Sabha B. Bill passed by Lok Sabha but pending in Rajya Sabha C. Bill passed by both Houses awaiting assent D. Bill for which joint sitting was notified

Answer: B. [FACT] It carries the expired Lok Sabha's unfinished mandate.

OM19. Charged expenditure

Charged expenditure on the Consolidated Fund:

- A. Is neither discussed nor voted. B. Is voted by both Houses. C. May be discussed but is not submitted to vote. D. Is voted only by Rajya Sabha.

Answer: C. [FACT] The non-votable character protects specified constitutional expenditures while allowing discussion.

OM20. Token cut

A Token Cut Motion reduces a demand by:

- A. Re 1 B. The full disputed amount C. Ten per cent D. Rs 100

Answer: D. [FACT] Re 1 is Policy Cut; Token Cut ventilates a specific grievance.

OM21. Public Account

Which fund does not require parliamentary appropriation for withdrawal?

- A. Public Account of India B. Consolidated Fund of India C. Contingency Fund after recoupment D. Every constitutional fund requires identical appropriation

Answer: A. [FACT] Public Account contains money held in trust; Consolidated Fund withdrawal requires appropriation.

OM22. PAC

Which correctly describes PAC?

- A. 30 Lok Sabha members; prospective estimates scrutiny B. 22 members (15 LS + 7 RS); examines CAG reports; Opposition chair by convention C. 22 members; examines only private corporations D. 31 members; every ministry has a separate PAC

Answer: B. [FACT] PAC is retrospective audit scrutiny; ministers are barred.

OM23. Estimates Committee

Which is correct?

- A. It has seven Rajya Sabha members. B. It is conventionally chaired by the Opposition. C. It has 30 Lok Sabha members and examines economy/efficiency in estimates. D. It decides whether expenditure was legally authorised after the fact.

Answer: C. [FACT] PAC handles post-expenditure CAG audit; Estimates is Lok Sabha-only and prospective.

OM24. DRSC composition

Each DRSC has:

- A. 30 members: 20 LS + 10 RS B. 22 members: 15 LS + 7 RS C. 31 members: 20 LS + 11 RS D. 31 members: 21 LS + 10 RS

Answer: D. [FACT] There were 17 in 1993 and 24 from 2004; 16 are LS-serviced and 8 RS-serviced.

OM25. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee

Which is correct?

- A. It has 30 members (20 LS + 10 RS) and examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation. B. It is the same institution as the NCSC. C. It has only Lok Sabha members. D. Ministers must constitute half its membership.

Answer: A. [FACT] It is a standing parliamentary committee; ministers are barred.

OM26. Rajya Sabha's exclusive powers

The controlled pair is:

A. Articles 110 and 123 B. Articles 249 and 312 C. Articles 75 and 113 D. Articles 108 and 111

Answer: B. [FACT] Rajya Sabha initiates national-interest State List legislation and creation of All-India Services.

OM27. Anti-defection merger

Which threshold supports the surviving merger exception?

A. One-third of the House B. Half of members present C. At least two-thirds of the legislature party D. Unanimous party membership

Answer: C. [FACT] The 91st Amendment deleted the former one-third split defence.

OM28. Nominated member under Tenth Schedule

Which statement is correct?

A. A nominated member can never join a party. B. A nominated member may join at any time without consequence. C. The rule is identical to that for an independent. D. A nominated member may join within six months; joining after that can disqualify.

Answer: D. [FACT] An independent is disqualified upon joining any party.

OM29. IPG

The Indian Parliamentary Group:

A. Is India's National Group in the IPU and main India Branch of the CPA. B. Is a wing of the Ministry of External Affairs. C. Represents governments at the United Nations. D. Is limited to Rajya Sabha members.

Answer: A. [FACT] IPG organises parliamentary exchange; IPU is global and CPA Commonwealth-specific.

OM30. 106th Amendment status

As of 16 August 2026:

A. The Act has not commenced. B. It commenced on 16 April 2026, but the reservation remains non-operational pending the Article 334A sequence. C. One-third of current Lok Sabha seats are already reserved. D. The quota necessarily ends in 2041.

Answer: B. [FACT] Commenced and operational are different registers; no end year should be derived.

OM31. Census trigger

What must occur immediately before delimitation can switch on the Article 334A reservation sequence?

A. Completion of houselisting alone B. Reference date of 1 March 2027 C. Publication of the relevant figures of the first post-commencement census D. Passage of an ordinary resolution

Answer: C. [FACT] Enumeration/reference dates are not publication dates.

OM32. 2026 delimitation package

Which statement is correct?

A. Lok Sabha's ceiling is now 850. B. Delimitation must now use the 2011 Census. C. The package created a binding precedent. D. The 131st Amendment Bill proposed 850 but was defeated for want of the Article 368 special majority.

Answer: D. [FACT] 298:230 cleared the total-membership limb but not two-thirds of 528 present and voting.

OM33. Money Bill judicial status

Which is the safest current formulation?

A. Article 110 says final, but narrow constitutional review remains and the *Rojer Mathew* larger issue has no visible final resolution as of 16 August 2026. B. Speaker certification is wholly immune from courts. C. *Rojer Mathew* finally

invalidated all Money Bills. D. *Puttaswamy* unanimously settled every Article 110 issue.

Answer: A. [FACT]/[CURRENT] The formulation preserves textual finality, narrow review and pending-status caution.

OM34. Deputy Speaker

Which statement is correct?

A. The Deputy Speaker is appointed by the Speaker. B. The House elects the Deputy Speaker, who has the Speaker's powers when presiding. C. The Constitution fixes a thirty-day election deadline. D. The office automatically falls vacant on every adjournment.

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 93 says "as soon as may be" but supplies no numerical deadline.

OM35. Parliamentary reform

Which reform most directly improves clause-level legislative scrutiny?

A. Abolishing Rajya Sabha B. Expanding every whip to every vote C. Default committee referral with reasoned urgency exceptions D. Treating every Bill as a Money Bill

Answer: C. [ANALYSIS] It targets the point where evidence and legal text can be tested without destroying emergency flexibility.

OM36. MPLADS

Which statement follows the controlled routed demand?

A. MPLADS is a constitutional entitlement. B. Its funds necessarily lapse at year-end. C. The current annual amount may be quoted without checking. D. It is a scheme with non-lapsable funds; current rupee amount requires live official verification.

Answer: D. [FACT]/[LIMIT] Stable scheme characteristics can be stated; live amounts cannot be guessed.

Remedial MCQs - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

RM1. President and membership

Which correction is accurate?

A. The President is an integral part of Parliament but not a member of either House. B. The President is a nominated Rajya Sabha member. C. Parliament excludes the President. D. The President votes in joint sittings.

Answer: A. The Article 79 architecture distinguishes institutional membership from being an integral constitutional organ.

RM2. Session rule

The Constitution requires:

A. Exactly three sessions every year B. No more than six months between the relevant sittings of successive sessions C. At least 100 Lok Sabha sitting days D. A Winter Session every November

Answer: B. Budget/Monsoon/Winter are conventions; Article 85 supplies the six-month ceiling, not a sitting-day quota.

RM3. Prorogation trap

What ordinarily happens to a pending Bill on prorogation?

A. It lapses if introduced by a private member. B. It becomes an ordinance. C. It survives. D. It goes automatically to joint sitting.

Answer: C. Prorogation ends a session; dissolution creates the selective lapse rules.

RM4. Speaker removal

Which statement is correct?

A. Removal uses a simple majority of members present and voting. B. No advance notice is required. C. Speaker must preside over the resolution. D. Removal needs a majority of all the then members after fourteen days' notice.

Answer: D. This is an effective majority; Article 96 separately bars the Speaker from presiding.

RM5. Financial Bill-I trap

A Financial Bill-I:

A. Starts only in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation, but Rajya Sabha retains full legislative power. B. Is always subject to the fourteen-day recommendation rule. C. Cannot go to joint sitting. D. Contains only Article 110 matters.

Answer: A. The presence of other matters takes it outside the narrow Money Bill procedure.

RM6. Joint-sitting exclusion

Which pair has no joint-sitting route?

A. Ordinary Bill and Financial Bill-I B. Money Bill and Constitution Amendment Bill C. Ordinary Bill and Financial Bill-II D. Government Bill and Private Member's Bill

Answer: B. Money Bills have Article 109 procedure; amendments require separate Article 368 passage.

RM7. Committee-number trap

Which statement is correct?

A. DRSCs were 24 from their introduction in 1993. B. Estimates Committee has 15 LS and 7 RS members. C. DRSCs were 17 in 1993 and 24 from 2004; each has 21 LS and 10 RS members. D. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee has 31 members.

Answer: C. The standard distractors wrongly backdate 24 or swap the 21+10 composition.

RM8. Privilege trap

After *Sita Soren*:

A. No speech in Parliament is protected. B. Members have immunity for a bribe if they later vote. C. Article 105 was repealed judicially. D. Bribery lacks privilege immunity, while bona fide speech/vote protection remains.

Answer: D. The judgment targets the separate criminal bargain, not legislative freedom of debate.

RM9. Rajya Sabha status

Which statement is most accurate?

A. Rajya Sabha is weaker on money/confidence, equal in major legislative fields and exclusive under Articles 249/312. B. Rajya Sabha is inferior in every field. C. Rajya Sabha alone votes demands for grants. D. Rajya Sabha may remove the Union ministry.

Answer: A. A graded comparison is required; blanket equality or inferiority is wrong.

RM10. Women's reservation trap

Which is correct as of 16 August 2026?

A. The Act remains uncommenced. B. The Act commenced, but operational reservation awaits publication-linked delimitation. C. Reservation automatically began with Census houselisting. D. Its end date is conclusively 2041.

Answer: B. Enacted, commenced and operational are three separate registers.

RM11. 2026 Bill arithmetic

The 131st Amendment Bill failed because:

A. It received fewer ayes than noes. B. It failed the total-membership-majority limb. C. It cleared a simple majority but failed two-thirds of members present and voting. D. Rajya Sabha rejected it after Lok Sabha passage.

Answer: C. 298 exceeded half of 543 but not two-thirds of 528; it never reached Rajya Sabha.

RM12. Deputy Speaker status

Which wording is safest?

A. The Deputy Speaker's office is permanently abolished. B. The Constitution requires election within thirty days. C. The office is certainly vacant on 16 August 2026. D. The 17th Lok Sabha had no Deputy Speaker; present status must be verified before asserting a current vacancy.

Answer: D. Date-qualified institutional claims avoid converting past vacancy into an unverified present fact.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. Explain how the constitutional design of parliamentary sessions both enables and limits executive accountability. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding: "Explain how" requires a mechanism, not merely definitions. Cover summoning rule, devices and the weak sitting-day floor.

Model solution

Claim: Session design keeps the executive periodically answerable but leaves the intensity of accountability to political control of the calendar.

Named evidence: **Article 85** prevents more than six months between sessions, ensuring at least two annual opportunities for scrutiny. Within sittings, starred questions, supplementaries, Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions demand explanation; **Article 75(3)** allows Lok Sabha to test confidence.

Analysis: Periodic summoning prevents indefinite executive rule without Parliament, while oral questions and motions convert presence into public responsibility.

Qualification: The Constitution fixes no minimum sitting days and does not mandate three named sessions. Executive influence over summoning, disruption and loss of Question Hour may satisfy Article 85 while weakening real scrutiny.

Verdict: The design guarantees recurrence, not adequacy. A predictable calendar and protected accountability time would convert the six-month floor into effective control.

Examiner comment: Strong because Article 85 is linked to actual devices and its design limitation, rather than treated as a calendar fact.

Why this earns marks: Direct thesis; two Articles; mechanism; qualification; feasible reform within 150-word scale.

M2. Legislative privilege is a functional immunity, not a personal impunity. Discuss with reference to *Sita Soren*. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding: Define function, apply the case and preserve the surviving immunity.

Model solution

Claim: Article 105 protects fearless legislative functioning, not private criminal bargains.

Named evidence: It immunises proceedings for speech and vote in Parliament and protects authorised parliamentary publication. Yet in ***Sita Soren v. Union of India (2024)*** a unanimous seven-judge Bench overruled *P.V. Narasimha Rao* and held that accepting a bribe for a speech or vote attracts no Article 105/194 immunity; bribery is complete on acceptance.

Analysis: The functional-nexus test explains the distinction: debate and voting require autonomy from external litigation, whereas a bribe subverts rather than enables that function.

Qualification: The judgment did not expose bona fide speeches or votes to ordinary suits. Nor does judicial review authorise courts to manage routine House procedure.

Verdict: Privilege remains a shield for institutional independence, but *Sita Soren* correctly denies its conversion into a personal criminal safe harbour.

Examiner comment: Uses exact case proposition and avoids the frequent overstatement that all speech immunity has disappeared.

Why this earns marks: Definition, Article, overruled precedent, functional analysis and precise qualification.

M3. The Money Bill procedure is necessary for popular control of finance but vulnerable to bicameral bypass. Critically examine. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: “Critically examine” requires the rationale, misuse risk, case law and a bounded verdict.

Model solution

Claim: Articles 109-110 legitimately privilege the directly elected Lok Sabha in narrowly fiscal legislation, but overbroad certification can convert financial primacy into general legislative supremacy.

Named evidence: A Money Bill must contain **only** Article 110(1)(a)-(g) matters and incidental provisions. It begins in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation; Rajya Sabha may only recommend within fourteen days, and no joint sitting exists. The Speaker certifies it, with Article 110 calling the decision final.

Analysis: This design protects supply and taxation from Upper-House obstruction and aligns financial responsibility with the House that can dismiss the ministry. However, classification also removes Rajya Sabha's amendment veto. Adding substantial non-fiscal provisions therefore harms bicameralism and federal revision.

Judicial evidence: *Puttaswamy (Aadhaar)*, 2018 upheld the Aadhaar route by 4:1; *Rojer Mathew* (2019) doubted the reasoning and referred the larger question to seven judges.

Qualification: Textual finality is not ordinary merits appeal, yet narrow constitutional review for illegality/misuse remains. As of 16 August 2026 no visible final larger-Bench resolution was located.

Verdict: Popular financial control requires the special procedure, but constitutional fidelity requires strict enforcement of “only”, reasoned certification and narrow review.

Examiner comment: Balances democratic rationale and federal cost, uses both leading cases and preserves current-status caution.

Why this earns marks: Article -> mechanism -> consequence -> cases -> qualification -> reform verdict.

M4. Parliament's power of the purse is exercised through a chain, not a single budget vote. Analyse. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Build the complete authorisation-to-audit cycle and identify weak links.

Model solution

Claim: Financial control is a sequence of disclosure, deliberation, authorisation, expenditure and audit rather than one annual approval.

Named evidence and analysis: **Article 112** requires the Annual Financial Statement and distinguishes charged from voted expenditure. Under **Article 113**, Lok Sabha alone votes demands for grants, using Policy, Economy and Token Cut Motions. DRSCs examine ministry demands before voting, though the **guillotine** may pass undiscussed demands. **Article 114** then requires an Appropriation Act before withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund, while the Finance Bill enacts taxation. **Articles 115-116** provide supplementary, additional, excess grants, vote on account, vote of credit and exceptional grants. After spending, the **CAG** audits and the **PAC** examines reports; excess expenditure is regularised only after this post-facto scrutiny.

Qualification: Rajya Sabha discusses but does not vote demands. Charged expenditure is discussed but not voted. Public Account withdrawal is outside appropriation. Majority discipline makes cut-motion success rare, and PAC review is retrospective.

Verdict: The chain is constitutionally comprehensive but only as strong as DRSC time, grant debate and audit follow-up. Protecting these stages matters more than ritual budget passage.

Examiner comment: The answer maps the entire cycle and differentiates charged expenditure, Public Account and Rajya Sabha's role.

Why this earns marks: Six named constitutional/institutional units linked analytically rather than listed.

M5. Delimitation after the population freeze is simultaneously a democratic-equality and a federal-fairness problem. Examine with reference to the women's reservation trigger. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Examine both normative claims, then integrate Article 334A and current controls.

Model solution

Claim: Restoring population-proportional representation answers malapportionment but may penalise States that reduced fertility, making delimitation a federal bargain rather than a cartographic exercise.

Named evidence: **Article 81(2)(a)** links State seats to population. The **42nd Amendment** froze allocation on 1971 figures; the **84th Amendment** extended readjustment until publication of the first post-2026 census figures; the **87th** enabled 2001-based boundary readjustment. Because Rajya Sabha is population-weighted rather than equal-per-State, low-growth States lack a US-Senate-type counterweight.

Women's-reservation link: The **106th Amendment** inserted Articles 330A, 332A and 334A. It commenced on **16 April 2026**, but Article 334A requires publication of relevant first post-commencement census figures and delimitation before reservation operates. Census 2027 is the trigger census, yet publication and delimitation dates are unknown.

Counterpoint: Permanent under-representation of populous citizens is itself a democratic deficit; the freeze cannot substitute forever for representation.

Qualification: The defeated 131st Amendment Bill's 850 ceiling and 2011 basis are not law. No State or women's-seat projection is valid.

Verdict: Reform must reconcile vote equality with demographic-performance fairness, possibly through negotiated House design, without forecasting an outcome the Constitution has not yet produced.

Examiner comment: Integrates static freeze law, federal theory and the exact commenced-but-not-operational sequence.

Why this earns marks: Balanced normative analysis with Articles, amendments, current trigger and explicit risk controls.

M6. "Parliament is strong in constitutional instruments but weak in their political use." Critically examine and propose reforms. (20 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Test both halves, cover the full accountability architecture and rank reforms.

Model solution

Claim: Parliament retains formidable powers over law, supply and executive survival, yet majority discipline and scarcity of scrutiny time often convert control into formal ratification.

Strength in instruments: Article 75(3) permits no-confidence removal; questions, motions and debates force explanation. Articles 112-114 require financial disclosure, grant voting and appropriation. Ordinary Bills need bicameral consent; DRSCs provide detailed ministry scrutiny; PAC-CAG review closes the audit loop. Rajya Sabha adds continuity and Articles 249/312.

Weakness in use: The Tenth Schedule discourages independent voting; government controls most business; disruption reduces Question Hour; the guillotine passes demands without debate; Bill referral is optional; ordinances and contested Money Bill routing compress scrutiny. Speaker-linked defection and certification powers create neutrality concerns.

Counter-evidence: Committee consensus, opposition-led PAC work, judicial review and public debate can alter policy even when the government wins every vote. Weakness varies with coalition arithmetic and institutional leadership.

Reform: create a predictable sitting calendar; protect questions and opposition time; make committee referral the default with reasoned urgency exceptions; strengthen research/action-taken review; narrow the whip to confidence/core supply; require timely, reasoned presiding-officer decisions.

Verdict: The constitutional hardware remains sound; political incentives and procedural time are the failing software. Reform should activate existing accountability before inventing new devices.

Examiner comment: Covers instruments, causal limits, counterevidence and a prioritised reform package within the directive.

Why this earns marks: Eight named evidence units and a memorable but qualified hardware/software verdict.

M7. Evaluate whether Rajya Sabha and parliamentary committees together can compensate for executive dominance of Lok Sabha. (20 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Evaluate two institutions jointly, specify what they can and cannot compensate for, and give a degree-based judgment.

Model solution

Claim: Rajya Sabha and committees can improve revision, information and financial audit, but cannot fully neutralise a disciplined executive majority controlling confidence, supply and House time.

Rajya Sabha contribution: It is equal on ordinary and constitutional amendment Bills, permanent, committee-integrated and capable of federal debate. **Articles 249 and 312** give it exclusive federal initiative. A government lacking an Upper-House majority must negotiate on non-Money legislation.

Committee contribution: The **24 DRSCs (21 LS + 10 RS each)** scrutinise demands, referred Bills and reports; **PAC (15+7)** connects CAG audit to parliamentary accountability; Estimates and CoPU add prospective and undertaking-specific scrutiny. Smaller forums encourage expertise and cross-party consensus.

Limits: Article 109 reduces Rajya Sabha to recommendations on Money Bills; it cannot vote demands or remove the ministry under Article 75(3). Joint-sitting numbers favour Lok Sabha. Committee reports are advisory, Bill referral varies and the executive can control information and follow-up. Overbroad Money Bill use may bypass both Upper-House veto and ordinary committee pressure.

Qualification: Influence is not measured only by government defeat; reports, delay, amendment and public reasons can improve law.

Verdict: Together they are strong compensating correctives but not a counter-government. Strict Article 110 classification, default referral, research capacity and protected scrutiny time are needed for meaningful balance.

Examiner comment: Integrates bicameral and committee mechanisms and defines compensation by scrutiny quality rather than vote defeat alone.

Why this earns marks: Joint institutional evaluation, exact committee evidence, structural limits and reform-linked verdict.